CVE-2026-123158 · NOV 8

A 257-byte password was root

Passwordless SSH accounts on Alpine let anyone in

THREE CORRECT DECISIONS

- musl caps crypt() at 256 bytes
- Past that it returns * as an error
- * in /etc/shadow means «no password»
- OpenSSH never checks what came back

COST OF THE SEAM

10 years

musl since 2012, OpenSSH since 2016

CVSS 8.1 · exploited in the wild 9 hours after disclosure

WHO IS AFFECTED

- Alpine, OpenWrt, Buildroot, Yocto
- Only with UsePAM no + passwords on
- glibc — Debian, Ubuntu, Fedora — safe
- Found by fuzzing: 17,600 odd logins

CHECK IN ONE MINUTE

- sshd -T | grep usepam
- awk -F: '$2=="*"' /etc/shadow
- Fix: upgrade to openssh 10.6p2
- Or set PasswordAuthentication no

TAKEAWAY

Nobody was wrong, the hole is real: it lived in the seam

t.me/aidacode